system, with competition as its regulator. This does not conform to the Bharatiya [Indian] philosophy. Socialism originated in its reaction to the problems created by Capitalism. Its objectives are commendable but its end result has failed to profit mankind. The reason is the analysis of society and individual by Karl Marx, the propounder of scientific socialism, is basically materialistic and inadequate.'[53] Furthermore, the party, in one of its economic policy documents, categorically stated that it considered 'Karl Marx as out of date as Adam Smith'. As a party document supporting the idea of bank nationalisation noted, '"*Das Capital*" [sic] is as irrelevant to the existing conditions as *The Wealth of Nations*. Even in USA, the industry is not that free. After approximately century of free banking, it was placed under official control after the depression of the 1930s. The Government extended to deposits the sort of protection it had conferred on bank notes in 1863.'[54]

This world view explains why even when Indira Gandhi nationalised the fourteen largest commercial banks in India in 1969,[55] the Jan Sangh did not oppose the move in principle. It only protested the manner of implementation. When I discussed this with the Congress's Jairam Ramesh, he said, 'Most people don't realise how left the Sangh was.' He picked up his phone to show me a scan of a late 1960s newspaper clipping with the blaring headline 'Jan Sangh Urges Takeover of All Big Foreign Firms', reporting on a party economic resolution that called for the nationalisation of all foreign banks operating in the country. 'Even [the late] Arun Jaitley [Modi's first finance minister] was surprised when I sent him this,' he said. 'This was a very clear strand in Sangh thinking.'[56]

In fact, apart from cultural issues, there was very little to separate the Jan Sangh and the Congress in the first two decades after Independence. A comparative study done by *The Times of India* of the Congress, the Praja Socialist Party (PSP), Communist and Jan Sangh manifestos in February 1957 found that 'in the final analysis, the electoral battle can be fought not so much on their broad programmes—which are very similar—as on their ability to implement these honestly and efficiently. Practically, *everybody is a Socialist today*.' Essentially, the four main parties of the time agreed on the need for establishing a socialist State. The 'differences